

Intel on a roll

Intel has a stunning first quarter and spoke about "Sandy Bridge" and "Tunnel Creek". Samples of Sandy Bridge have also started to ship



Apple of Dell's eye

A few photos of Dells new iPad look-alike have leaked, it's Android powered

...SNEAK PEEK...

Apple iPad

A touch-feel first look

While not officially available yet, Digit got its excited little paws on the Apple iPad a while back. The thoughts that ran through our head when we first laid eyes upon it were: (1) wow, (2) it's smaller than we thought, and finally, (3) it's heavier than we would like it to be. The Apple iPad is about 200gm too heavy for most postures which do not involve assisted support of the device and does not make for a comfortable viewing experience over an extended period of time.

If the weight brings a tiny frown to your face, the iPad's screen will turn it upside down and split it ear to ear. The Apple iPad's IPS display is a real winner with an amazing viewing angle and capacitive multitouch support. It turns the iPad into a new window to traditional content such as websites, e-books, comics, photos, maps, etc. The iPad experience can be summed up with the word "immediate". Everything is literally at your fingertips, and almost every content on screen is willing to be manipulated by said fingertips – your first few minutes with the iPad will be spent tapping, twisting, stretching, zooming, and flipping through content, with a giggle or two on your lips. It truly is a fresh way to discover old content.

As an internet device

While Safari is capable enough, the browser is let-down by the 256MB of RAM in the iPad. You won't be able to browse certain forums or sites, especially those with lots of images, or worse - GIFs. The browser might stall and fail to completely load such pages. Safari also doesn't render some sites as it should - but these are few and far in-between. However, since Apple refuses to support Flash, some sites will simply not work. You thus can't access the entire Internet on the iPad. Hopefully, the industry will sort this mess out and we can move forward without leaving our favourite sites behind.

don't live in that parallel universe, we can't have both (yet). The issue? Depending on your eyes, you might not be able to handle long periods of reading on the Apple iPad's screen due to its backlit nature. The iPad's dpi is also not as high as the iPhone's so the fonts rendered aren't as sharp as the iPhone's.

As a comic book reader

The screen is just a tad smaller than ideal. About 2-inches more and it would make a

prepare to rip them; ditto for Blu-rays. If you have movies from other sources, then consider buying Air Video – an excellent application that transcodes everything that isn't tied down by DRM. It does the transcoding on-the-fly, over-the-air and streams it to your Apple iPad. It also handles off-line transcoding and queues. Bottom line: if you have a lot of videos, Air Video will be the best \$3 you will spend on the Apple iPad.

As a gaming console

The Apple iPad is currently the most powerful handheld console. So what's the issue? Controls: A lack of any physical keys will invariably dampen your experience with more traditional games and genres. Over time, you could grow accustomed to on-screen d-pads and thumbsticks and what-nots; especially for slower genres such as RPG and strategy. But your mileage may vary. If you can overcome that hurdle – the games are excellent on this platform. In many ways, the Apple iPad is the true indie platform. You will often come across a gem that will hook you for a week, developed by a bunch of geeks (and often a small bunch too), sold for \$0.99, or often for free.

Our first impressions of the Apple iPad are mixed. While it offers a great screen, and an excellent repository of applications via its Store, the device is not without issues – whether hardware, or software. Before you decide whether to buy or import the iPad, visit us online for a more detailed look at the device including grey market availability and a look at some of the highlight apps.



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perfect comic book replacement as comics would fit as is. Right now, comic readers need to do a bit of zooming to make the panels readable. Readers such as Marvel Comics offer a very cool panel-fly effect which pans, zooms, and moves around comic panels lending some drama to a comic book.

The Apple iPad as a movie device

It's perfect. Almost. Again, the source of your videos would determine your experience. If you have a lot of DVDs, then



Read the entire, seven page review on the Apple iPad on our website. Visit: www.thinkdigit.com/d/iPad